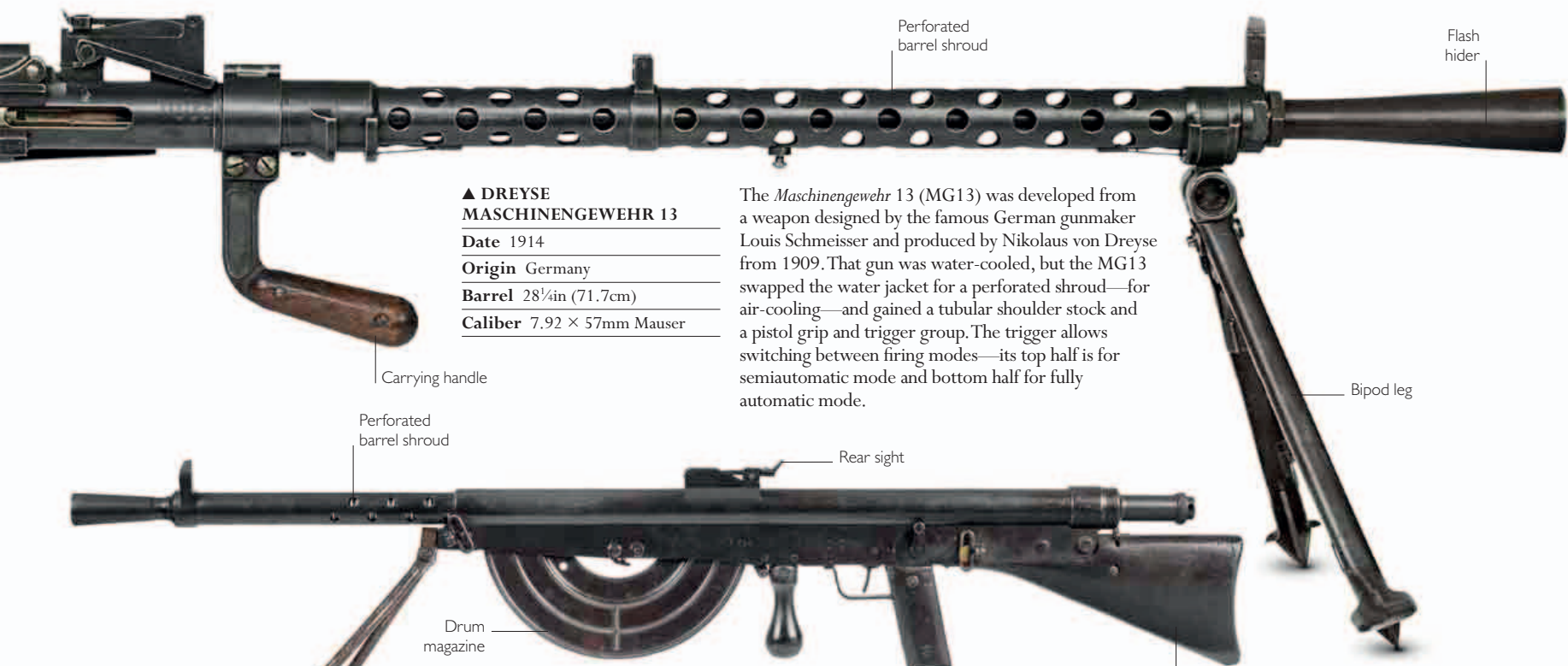




▲ DREYSE
MASCHINENGEWEHR 13
Date 1914
Origin Germany
Barrel 28¼in (71.7cm)
Caliber 7.92 × 57mm Mauser

The *Maschinengewehr* 13 (MG13) was developed from a weapon designed by the famous German gunmaker Louis Schmeisser and produced by Nikolaus von Dreyse from 1909. That gun was water-cooled, but the MG13 swapped the water jacket for a perforated shroud—for air-cooling—and gained a tubular shoulder stock and a pistol grip and trigger group. The trigger allows switching between firing modes—its top half is for semiautomatic mode and bottom half for fully automatic mode.



▲ CHAUCHAT MLE 1915
Date 1907
Origin France
Barrel 19in (48.26cm)
Caliber 8 × 50mm

More properly described as a machine-rifle, since it was intended for use by one person and could be fired in semiautomatic mode, the Chauchat has the dubious distinction of being known as the worst light machine-gun ever made. It was prone to jamming and the thin-walled pressed steel magazines were far too delicate for field use.



FULL VIEW

▲ SPANDAU 08/15 AIRCRAFT
MACHINE-GUN

Date 1915
Origin Germany
Barrel 28¼in (71.9cm)
Caliber 7.92 × 57mm Mauser

Though it was also used by infantrymen, fitted with a butt and pistol grip, the LMG08/15 was developed as a fixed gun for use in aircraft. In this form, it had a synchronizer cable linked to an interrupter gear, which allowed it to fire forward—right through the propeller's arc.